

CLAT Express - December 2025: Practice Quizzes

MCQ: +1 for a correct answer, -0.25 for a wrong answer. TITA (type-in-the-answer): +1, no negative marking.

Multiple-choice passages

Aravalli Range: Facts and Rulings

The Aravalli range is one of the oldest mountain systems in India. It runs through Gujarat, Rajasthan and Haryana, and reaches Delhi. The range acts as a natural barrier that slows the spread of the Thar Desert, because it blocks dust-laden desert winds. It also influences the southwest monsoon by guiding moisture-laden winds towards the Indo-Gangetic Plains. In winter, its hills shield the northern plains from cold, dry winds. Its forested stretches help clean the air of the National Capital Region by absorbing carbon dioxide and trapping fine particles. Its forests are also home to many plant and animal species. Rocks in the range allow rainwater to seep into the ground, which supports groundwater in semi-arid areas. The area also supports mining-based livelihoods and industries. Because of these uses, the range has faced pressure from mining and urban growth for many years. Courts and government bodies have therefore introduced several measures to limit mining and restore forests. In 2025, the Supreme Court accepted a uniform scientific definition of an Aravalli hill, based on an expert committee's advice. The definition determines which landforms receive protection, and it has raised concern that mining and construction could expand into areas left outside it. Understanding both the ecology and the legal steps helps explain why the range is in the news.

Q1.

Which peak is the highest in the Aravalli range, and in which state is it located?

- (A) Guru Shikhar, Rajasthan
- (B) Champaner, Gujarat
- (C) Raisina Hill, Delhi
- (D) Mount Abu, Haryana

Q2.

Approximately how old is the Aravalli mountain system, the oldest in India?

- (A) About 2 billion years
- (B) About 500 million years
- (C) About 1 billion years
- (D) About 3 billion years

Q3.

What is the total length of the Aravalli range from Gujarat to Delhi?

- (A) 500 km
- (B) 800 km
- (C) 1000 km
- (D) 692 km

Q4.

Assertion (A): The Aravalli range is a source of valuable minerals such as copper and zinc.

Reason (R): The range is a source of the Luni and Banas rivers.

In the context of the above two statements, which of the following is correct?

- (A) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (B) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (C) A is true but R is false
- (D) A is false but R is true

Q5.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Champaner	A. Highest peak of the range
II. Raisina Hill	B. Originates in the range
III. Guru Shikhar	C. End point of the range in Delhi
IV. Luni river	D. Starting point of the range in Gujarat

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-A, II-B, III-C, IV-D
- (B) I-C, II-D, III-B, IV-A
- (C) I-D, II-C, III-A, IV-B
- (D) I-A, II-D, III-C, IV-B

Q6.

Consider the following statements about the Supreme Court's 2025 ruling on the Aravalli range:

- I. Any landform rising 100 m or more above its immediate local terrain is an Aravalli hill.
- II. Clusters of such hills within 500 m, including intervening areas, form an Aravalli range.
- III. Mining is permitted in core or inviolate areas such as protected areas and wetlands.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and II only
- (B) II and III only
- (C) I and III only
- (D) I, II and III

Q7.

How many of the following statements about the Aravalli range are correct?

- I. The range extends 692 km from Gujarat to Delhi.
- II. Guru Shikhar, the highest peak, lies in Haryana.
- III. The Aravalli Green Wall Project was launched in 2019.

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only two
- (C) Only three
- (D) None

Key features check

Rural employment policy has been under review since the government introduced the Viksit Bharat - Guarantee for Rozgar and Aajeevika Mission (Gramin) Bill, 2025 in the Lok Sabha. The proposal would replace MGNREGA, which critics say has grown outdated as rural livelihoods and employment patterns have changed. Concerns have also been raised that the older scheme created assets of low utility or limited durability. The government presents the new law as part of its national vision of Viksit Bharat by 2047.

The funding model is also changing. The earlier scheme relied on open-ended funding that was largely borne by the Centre. The new bill moves to a model of shared financial responsibility between the Centre and the States, with different ratios for different regions. Supporters argue that predictable allocations make budgeting easier and help the Centre target spending.

Planning is meant to begin in villages. Gram panchayats prepare their own plans, which are linked to infrastructure programmes and then combined at the national level. Panchayats are also to be graded on development indicators. Oversight will come from councils at the Centre and in the States, along with steering committees that advise on allocations and coordination between

ministries.

Farmers have long reported labour shortages during sowing and harvest seasons, and the bill gives States a tool to respond. Overall, the government says the reform will strengthen rural income security while improving transparency and accountability.

Q1.

What is the statutory guarantee of unskilled manual work per rural household per financial year under the proposed bill?

- (A) 125 days
- (B) 100 days
- (C) 150 days
- (D) 180 days

Q2.

Assertion (A): State governments can suspend the scheme for up to 60 days during sowing and harvesting seasons.

Reason (R): The suspension is meant to ensure availability of agricultural labour during these seasons.

- (A) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (B) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (C) A is true but R is false
- (D) A is false but R is true

Q3.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Viksit Bharat National Rural Infrastructure Stack	A. Skilling, toolkits and credit linkage for artisans
II. PM Gati Shakti	B. Aggregates Viksit Gram Panchayat Plans for national planning
III. SVAMITVA	C. Infrastructure convergence with village plans
IV. PM Vishwakarma	D. Property cards to rural households

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-D, II-C, III-B, IV-A
- (B) I-D, II-B, III-A, IV-C
- (C) I-A, II-D, III-B, IV-C
- (D) I-B, II-C, III-D, IV-A

Q4.

Consider the following statements about the VB-G RAM G Bill:

- I. Panchayats that underperform on development indicators may receive higher allocations.
- II. Works must align with five national priorities for durable asset creation.
- III. Wages are envisaged to be paid weekly, instead of within a 15-day cycle.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and II only
- (B) I and III only
- (C) II and III only
- (D) I, II and III

Q5.

How many of the following statements about MGNREGA and the proposed bill are correct?

- I. MGNREGA was enacted in 2005.
 - II. For most states, the Centre-State funding ratio under the bill is 60:40.
 - III. Under MGNREGA, the central government bears 100% of the cost of unskilled labour wages.
 - IV. The bill envisages paying wages within 15 days of completion of work.
- (A) Only one
 - (B) Only two
 - (C) Only three
 - (D) All four

Q6.

What share of funding is borne by the Centre for North-Eastern and Himalayan States under the bill?

- (A) 90%
- (B) 75%
- (C) 60%
- (D) 100%

Q7.

Which of the following is NOT one of the four national priorities for durable asset creation under the bill?

- (A) Water Security
- (B) Core Rural Infrastructure
- (C) Livelihood-related Infrastructure
- (D) Digital Banking Infrastructure

Q8.

Within how many days of a household's application must work be provided, failing which an unemployment allowance is payable?

- (A) 15 days
- (B) 7 days
- (C) 10 days
- (D) 30 days

Lok Adalat basics

Lok Adalat, whose name means 'People's Court', is a forum based on Gandhian principles that offers an expeditious and cost-effective alternative to dispute resolution through the courts. It works as a forum where cases that are pending in a court can be taken up, and disputes that are still at the pre-litigation stage can be brought before it as well. The aim is to have these matters compromised or settled in an amicable manner. A Lok Adalat organised for an area consists of serving or retired judicial officers and other persons of that area, as specified by the agency that organises it. In general, the panel has a judicial officer as Chairman, with a lawyer and a social worker as Members. Lok Adalats have been given statutory status by law, which places them firmly within India's legal framework. Every award made by a Lok Adalat is final and binding on all parties to the dispute. The organising authority for Lok Adalats is the National Legal Services Authority. Because the process rests on agreement between the parties, it saves time and money compared with a long trial. The panel's role is to help the parties arrive at a common outcome. The mechanism is therefore a key part of India's alternative dispute resolution system.

Q1.

In which year was the first Lok Adalat in India organised?

- (A) 1982
- (B) 1987
- (C) 1995
- (D) 2002

Q2.

Under which Act do Lok Adalats have statutory status?

- (A) Indian Penal Code, 1860
- (B) Civil Procedure Code, 1908
- (C) Constitution of India, Article 21
- (D) Legal Services Authorities Act, 1987

Q3.

Assertion (A): Every award made by a Lok Adalat is final and binding on all parties to the dispute.

Reason (R): Lok Adalats can settle offences that are non-compoundable under any law.

- (A) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (B) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (C) A is true but R is false
- (D) A is false but R is true

Q4.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Permanent Lok Adalat	A. Chief Justice of the State High Court as Patron-in-Chief
II. National Lok Adalat	B. Chief Justice of India as Patron-in-Chief
III. NALSA	C. Disputes on public utility services
IV. High Court Legal Services Committee	D. Held across India on a single day

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-B, II-C, III-A, IV-D
- (B) I-C, II-A, III-B, IV-D
- (C) I-C, II-D, III-B, IV-A
- (D) I-A, II-B, III-C, IV-D

Q5.

Consider the following statements:

- I. The National Judicial Data Grid was developed by the National Informatics Centre.
- II. SUVAS is a machine-assisted translation tool trained by artificial intelligence.
- III. SUPACE is a portal that secures electronic transmission of interim orders.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I only
- (B) I and II only
- (C) II and III only
- (D) I, II and III

Q6.

Consider the following statements about Permanent Lok Adalats:

- I. They were made possible by a 2002 amendment to the Legal Services Authorities Act, 1987.
- II. They have jurisdiction over any offence, including offences not punishable by law.
- III. Their judgments are final and binding on all parties involved.

How many of the above statements are correct?

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only two
- (C) Only three
- (D) None

Q7.

Which Supreme Court case held that a Lok Adalat is purely conciliatory?

- (A) Swapnil Tripathi v. Supreme Court of India (2018)
- (B) Kesavananda Bharati v. State of Kerala (1973)
- (C) Maneka Gandhi v. Union of India (1978)
- (D) State of Punjab vs Jalour Singh (2008)

Q8.

What does FASTER stand for in the Supreme Court context?

- (A) Fast and Secured Transmission of Electronic Records
- (B) Fast Access System for Tribunal Electronic Records
- (C) Fully Automated Secure Transmission of Evidence
- (D) Fast Automated System for Recording

Assam Bill: practice MCQs

Polygamy is a marital system in which a person has more than one spouse at the same time. Its prevalence in India is measured through national family surveys, which ask married women about their husbands' marital arrangements and compare results across religions and states. Such data helps lawmakers judge whether a practice needs stronger legal action. In 2025 the Assam Assembly passed a Prohibition of Polygamy Bill, described as introducing strict penalties to curb polygamous practices. Its stated objective is to eliminate such practices in the state. The Bill applies to residents of Assam. It addresses marriages that were formed before the law came into force, and it includes provisions for women who were affected by polygamous marriages. Existing Indian law already treats the issue in different ways. Some statutes prohibit bigamy for certain communities, while the personal laws of other communities allow multiple marriages within limits. The Bill therefore sits at the meeting point of criminal law, family law and personal laws, and its design reflects the need to balance social reform with the rights of communities and individuals. Any such law must also be read alongside Fundamental Rights, because a marriage that violates them can be legally challenged under some personal laws. Debates on the subject often return to the same question, namely how far a single legal framework can respect the diversity of religious communities across the country.

Q1.

Which state has the highest rate of polygamy in India according to NFHS-5 (2019-21)?

- (A) Meghalaya
- (B) Assam
- (C) West Bengal
- (D) Tripura

Q2.

What does the Grandfather Clause in the Bill ensure?

- (A) Invalidates previous polygamous marriages
- (B) Exempts all elderly citizens
- (C) Protects patriarchal systems
- (D) Validates pre-law marriages compliant with personal or customary laws

Q3.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Maximum imprisonment for a second marriage while the first is valid	A. NFHS-5 (2019-21)
II. Source of national polygamy data	B. Section 82
III. Offence of marrying again during a spouse's lifetime	C. Article 342
IV. Article excluding Scheduled Tribes	D. 10 years

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-A, II-C, III-B, IV-D
- (B) I-D, II-B, III-A, IV-C
- (C) I-D, II-A, III-B, IV-C
- (D) I-A, II-B, III-C, IV-D

Q4.

Consider the following statements about the Assam Prohibition of Polygamy Bill 2025:

- I. The Bill covers individuals engaged in polygamous marriages outside Assam.
- II. The Bill applies to those availing benefits from Assam's welfare schemes.
- III. The Bill bars convicted individuals only from government jobs and schemes.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and II only
- (B) II and III only
- (C) I and III only
- (D) I, II and III

Q5.

How many of the following statements about the Bill are correct?

- I. Entering a second marriage while the first is legally valid attracts imprisonment under the Bill.
- II. Village heads and qazis can be held accountable for facilitating polygamous marriages.
- III. Convicted persons may contest elections after serving their sentence.

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only two
- (C) Only three
- (D) None of the above

Q6.

What fund does the Bill introduce for women affected by polygamous marriages?

- (A) Legal Aid Fund
- (B) Rehabilitation Fund
- (C) Housing Fund
- (D) State Victim Relief Fund

Q7.

Which legal framework does the Bill aim to strengthen?

- (A) Family law ensuring monogamous marriages
- (B) Criminal law
- (C) Property law
- (D) Constitutional law

Why the rupee weakened in 2025

The Indian rupee depreciated by over 5% in 2025 and, by December, had crossed 90 per US dollar. The fall was not the result of one sudden shock. Analysts instead pointed to a mix of global and domestic pressures that had been building over time. Strength in the US dollar was a major backdrop, and the rupee was also hit by delays in a trade arrangement between India and the United States that investors had been anticipating. Money flowed out of Indian markets as global risk sentiment shifted. On the domestic side, the gap between what India buys from abroad and what it sells drew close attention. Crude oil prices rose, and some exports to major destinations were under strain. Demand for dollars also grew in the currency market as businesses and traders responded to the expectation of further weakness in the rupee. The 90 level drew particular attention from traders, who treat such round-number thresholds as important. Market participants said the fall had built up over time rather than arriving in a single day. Experts said the rupee's path in the months ahead would depend on global financial conditions, external trade developments and domestic economic indicators.

Q1.

Which set of imports did the booklet identify as widening India's trade deficit in 2025?

- (A) Only agricultural products
- (B) Only textiles
- (C) Only services
- (D) Gold, electronics, crude and machinery

Q2.

Which group of investors does the booklet say withdrew funds aggressively, adding to capital outflows?

- (A) Foreign Portfolio Investors (FPIs)
- (B) Domestic mutual funds
- (C) Non-Resident Indians
- (D) The Reserve Bank of India

Q3.

What is the maximum US tariff on Indian exports cited in the booklet's account of 2025 rupee pressure?

- (A) 25%
- (B) 35%
- (C) 50%
- (D) 60%

Q4.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. FPI withdrawals	A. Concerns over tariffs and export access
II. Higher crude oil prices	B. Speculative dollar demand
III. Importers front-loading dollar purchases	C. Worsened import bill
IV. Delays in the initial tranche of the India-US trade deal	D. Capital outflow from India

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-C, II-A, III-B, IV-D
- (B) I-D, II-C, III-B, IV-A
- (C) I-A, II-D, III-C, IV-B
- (D) I-C, II-B, III-A, IV-D

Q5.

Consider the following statements about the rupee's weakness in 2025:

- I. Foreign Portfolio Investors withdrew funds aggressively from India.
- II. India was seen as a liquidity source amid global risk rebalancing.
- III. Higher crude oil prices reduced India's import bill.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) II and III only
- (B) I and III only
- (C) I and II only
- (D) I, II and III

Q6.

Consider the following statements:

- I. Global uncertainty shifted capital to US Treasuries and the US dollar as safe havens.
- II. Speculative dollar demand came mainly from exporters selling dollars early.
- III. Lower investor confidence reduced inflows into India.
- IV. The United States imposed tariffs of up to 25 per cent on Indian exports.

How many of the above statements are correct?

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only two
- (C) Only three
- (D) None

Q7.

By how much did the Indian rupee depreciate in 2025, according to the booklet?

- (A) Over 3%
- (B) Over 7%
- (C) Over 10%
- (D) Over 5%

Repo Cut and Goldilocks: MCQ Practice

In December 2025, the Reserve Bank of India (RBI) cut the policy repo rate to 5.25 per cent. The move was intended to sustain what the RBI called a Goldilocks phase, a balanced condition that is neither too hot nor too cold. In such a phase, the economy grows strongly while inflation stays low. Monetary policy works through the repo rate in both directions. When inflation rises, the central bank can make borrowing costly, which curbs excessive spending and slows investment. When the economy needs more money, the central bank lowers the rate, so that loans become cheaper for banks, which then pass lower interest rates on to borrowers and businesses. The December cut was

justified on three grounds. Inflation had fallen sharply below the lower end of the target range, which created room for easing without risking price instability. Growth also remained robust despite global uncertainties. Finally, global trade headwinds and other external pressures made a pre-emptive stimulus useful in offsetting a slowing expansion. Lower rates are expected to boost lending, consumption and investment. They may, however, weaken the rupee and reduce returns on fixed deposits, which could discourage household savings. The rate decision itself is taken by a statutory body called the Monetary Policy Committee, which works within India's flexible inflation-targeting framework.

Q1.

How many of the following statements about the Monetary Policy Committee are correct?

- I. The MPC is required to meet at least four times in a year.
- II. The quorum for an MPC meeting is five members.
- III. The RBI Governor has a casting vote in case of a tie.
- IV. MPC decisions are taken by unanimous vote.

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only two
- (C) Only three
- (D) All four

Q2.

By how many basis points did the RBI cut the repo rate in December 2025?

- (A) 50 basis points
- (B) 75 basis points
- (C) 25 basis points
- (D) 100 basis points

Q3.

What was India's inflation rate in October 2025, as cited in the booklet?

- (A) 1.7%
- (B) 2.0%
- (C) 4.0%
- (D) 0.3%

Q4.

Consider the following statements about the repo and related rates.

- I. The repo rate is the rate at which RBI lends money to commercial banks.
- II. The reverse repo rate is the rate at which RBI borrows money from commercial banks.
- III. The Bank Rate is a short-term rate at which RBI lends money to other banks.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and II only
- (B) II and III only
- (C) I and III only
- (D) I, II and III

Q5.

What was the total reduction in the repo rate by the RBI during 2025, in basis points?

- (A) 100 basis points
- (B) 150 basis points
- (C) 125 basis points
- (D) 175 basis points

Q6.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Repo Rate	A. Long-term rate at which central bank lends to other banks
II. Bank Rate	B. Share of deposits banks must hold as cash with RBI
III. Cash Reserve Ratio	C. Window for banks to borrow overnight funds at higher rate than repo
IV. Marginal Standing Facility	D. Rate at which RBI lends money to commercial banks

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-D, II-C, III-A, IV-B
- (B) I-D, II-B, III-C, IV-A
- (C) I-B, II-A, III-C, IV-D
- (D) I-D, II-A, III-B, IV-C

Summit economics and payments

India and Russia used their 23rd Annual Summit in New Delhi to widen cooperation well beyond their traditional areas. The summit came after the two countries upgraded their ties to a special and privileged strategic partnership, and it marked 25 years of that relationship. The leaders adopted a comprehensive programme meant to diversify bilateral ties beyond defence and energy. Its work is coordinated by a commission that handles trade, economic, scientific, technical and cultural cooperation between the two governments, and that body serves as the apex forum for economic dialogue between them.

Trade and finance formed a central part of the discussions. Both sides agreed to boost settlements in national currencies, and they decided to work on interoperability of their payment systems and digital currencies. Officials described this as a way to reduce reliance on Western financial channels. The leaders also reaffirmed their commitment to energy security, with continued support for nuclear power projects in India, including small modular reactors and future civil nuclear work.

The summit also addressed terrorism. Both countries called for strict action against all UN-listed terrorist organisations and endorsed a zero-tolerance approach grounded in international law. Connectivity and mobility were additional priorities, as the two governments pursued new routes for cargo and skilled professionals.

Q1.

Which Indian minister chairs the IRIGC-TEC, the commission that coordinates Programme 2030?

- (A) External Affairs Minister of India
- (B) Prime Minister of India
- (C) Finance Minister of India
- (D) Commerce and Industry Minister of India

Q2.

What trade target has been set for India and Russia under Programme 2030 (in US dollars)?

- (A) \$50 billion
- (B) \$68.7 billion
- (C) \$100 billion
- (D) \$120 billion

Q3.

Payment-system cooperation under the summit seeks to bypass which Western-led financial messaging system?

- (A) NEFT
- (B) RTGS
- (C) SWIFT
- (D) UPI

Q4.

Assertion (A): Russia formally joined the International Big Cat Alliance during the summit.

Reason (R): India welcomed Russia's interest in joining the International Solar Alliance.

- (A) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (B) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (C) A is true but R is false
- (D) A is false but R is true

Q5.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Programme 2030	A. \$100 billion by 2030
II. Payment-system interoperability	B. Built in India with Russian cooperation
III. Trade target by 2030	C. Diversify ties beyond defence and energy
IV. Kudankulam Nuclear Power Plant	D. Bypass SWIFT

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-B, II-A, III-C, IV-D
- (B) I-C, II-D, III-A, IV-B
- (C) I-D, II-B, III-A, IV-C
- (D) I-C, II-A, III-D, IV-B

Q6.

Consider the following statements about the outcomes of the 23rd India-Russia Annual Summit:

- I. Negotiations on a free trade agreement with the Eurasian Economic Union are to be fast-tracked.
- II. The proposed Chennai-Vladivostok sea route passes through the Malacca Strait.
- III. The 2030 trade target of \$100 billion has already been reached.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and III only
- (B) II and III only
- (C) I, II and III
- (D) I and II only

Q7.

How many of the following statements about the 23rd India-Russia Annual Summit are correct?

- I. Putin's visit to India was his first in four years, since 2021.
- II. Russia formally joined the International Solar Alliance during the summit.
- III. Both sides denounced the Pahalgam attack (2025) and the Crocus City Hall attack (2024).
- IV. The trade target under Programme 2030 is \$68.7 billion.

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only two
- (C) Only three
- (D) None of the above

Q8.

The proposed Chennai-Vladivostok Maritime Corridor aims to reduce the time taken to transport cargo to Russia by what percentage?

- (A) 25 per cent
- (B) 30 per cent
- (C) 40 per cent
- (D) 50 per cent

The Durand Line Border

The Durand Line is a long international boundary that separates Pakistan from Afghanistan. Its origins lie in the colonial period, when British India and Afghanistan were locked in a long and often violent relationship. Britain fought several wars with Afghanistan, and some of these conflicts ended in settlements that changed how Afghanistan's external relations were handled. The boundary itself was fixed through a late nineteenth-century arrangement that involved British officials and the Afghan ruler of the time. Its path crosses demanding terrain, from mountain ranges in the north to deserts further south. When British rule over the subcontinent ended, the boundary passed to Pakistan, while Afghanistan has continued to question its legitimacy. Many communities that live near the line share ethnic and cultural ties across it, so the boundary affects families and tribes as well as governments. Tensions along the frontier have periodically resurfaced, and recent allegations of airstrikes near the line have drawn fresh attention to a dispute that began more than a century ago. Students preparing for current affairs should understand both the historical background and the modern implications of this boundary, since disputes of this kind shape regional security and diplomacy. Diplomatic exchanges about the border have often focused on whether the boundary is legitimate, and these debates continue to shape relations between the neighbouring states.

Q1.

Which 1893 agreement fixed the Durand Line?

- (A) Treaty of Gandamak
- (B) Treaty of Lahore
- (C) Treaty of Rawalpindi
- (D) Durand Agreement

Q2.

Which treaty ended the 1919 Anglo-Afghan War?

- (A) Treaty of Gandamak
- (B) Durand Agreement
- (C) Simla Agreement
- (D) Treaty of Rawalpindi

Q3.

The Wakhan Corridor was created as part of the Durand Line arrangement for what purpose?

- (A) A strategic buffer separating British and Russian spheres
- (B) A trade route linking Kabul and Delhi
- (C) A pilgrimage route for Pashtun tribes
- (D) A river boundary with Iran

Q4.

In which year did the Durand Line pass to Pakistan?

- (A) 1893
- (B) 1919
- (C) 1947
- (D) 1961

Q5.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Anglo-Afghan War (1839-42)	A. Restored Afghanistan's foreign policy autonomy
II. Treaty of Gandamak (1879)	B. British intervention failed
III. Treaty of Rawalpindi (1919)	C. Drew the Durand Line
IV. Durand Agreement (1893)	D. Britain gained control over Afghanistan's foreign affairs

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-C, II-D, III-B, IV-A
- (B) I-C, II-B, III-D, IV-A
- (C) I-B, II-D, III-A, IV-C
- (D) I-D, II-C, III-B, IV-A

Q6.

Consider the following statements about the Durand Line:

- I. The Durand Line passes through the Karakoram Mountain Range.
- II. Pakistan inherited the Durand Line after Partition in 1947.
- III. Afghanistan formally recognised the Durand Line soon after 1947.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) II and III only
- (B) I and II only
- (C) I and III only
- (D) I, II and III

Courts, Waqf and Competition Law

Indian courts have long held a power to punish persons who disrespect them, and recent developments have brought this power back into focus. In a recent ruling, the Supreme Court stated that the power to punish for criminal contempt is not a personal shield for judges. The Court also stressed that judges have the authority to forgive an offender, and that forgiveness can be given alongside punishment. Contempt is generally divided into two broad categories, and each category protects the justice system in a different way. Separately, the government has moved to bring Waqf property records into a single digital system. A minister recently made an announcement about the registration of Waqf properties. The system, known as UMEED, is meant to make the management of Waqf properties more efficient and transparent. Meanwhile, the Competition Commission of India has started to examine a sudden disruption to airline services. The regulator is checking whether a dominant company has misused its market position, which is a matter covered by competition law. Such steps show how courts, regulators and ministries each shape the rules that citizens and companies must follow in everyday life. Each institution in these stories works within a defined legal framework, which is why the exact provisions matter.

Q1.

Which provision makes the Supreme Court a Court of Record with power to punish for contempt of itself?

- (A) Article 215, for the High Courts
- (B) Article 129, for the High Courts
- (C) Article 215, for the Supreme Court
- (D) Article 129, for the Supreme Court

Q2.

Which Act governs contempt proceedings in India?

- (A) Waqf Act, 1995
- (B) Contempt of Courts Act, 1971
- (C) Competition Act, 2002
- (D) Energy Conservation Act, 2001

Q3.

Read the two statements and choose the correct option.

Assertion (A): Criminal contempt includes acts that scandalise or lower the authority of a court.

Reason (R): Criminal contempt covers wilful disobedience of a court's judgment or order.

- (A) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (B) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (C) A is true but R is false
- (D) A is false but R is true

Q4.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Article 129	A. High Courts
II. Article 215	B. Competition Act, 2002
III. Competition Commission of India	C. Waqf Act, 1995
IV. UMEED portal	D. Supreme Court

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-D, II-A, III-C, IV-B
- (B) I-D, II-A, III-B, IV-C
- (C) I-B, II-D, III-C, IV-A
- (D) I-B, II-A, III-C, IV-D

Q5.

Consider the following statements:

- I. Criminal contempt covers acts that scandalise or lower the authority of a court.
- II. Civil contempt covers wilful breach of an undertaking given to a court.
- III. The Competition Commission of India was established in 2002.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and III only
- (B) II and III only
- (C) I and II only
- (D) I, II and III

Q6.

Consider the following statements:

- I. The CCI consists of a Chairperson and 2 to 6 Members.
- II. The Ministry of Corporate Affairs is the nodal agency for UMEED.
- III. Civil contempt includes wilful disobedience of a court's judgment.

How many of the above statements are correct?

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only two
- (C) Only three
- (D) None

Q7.

The CCI has taken cognisance of flight disruptions of which airline to probe a possible abuse of dominant position?

- (A) Air India
- (B) SpiceJet
- (C) Akasa Air
- (D) IndiGo

Type-in-the-answer passages

Restoring the Green Cover

Restoring degraded land has become a central goal in the Aravalli region, where mining and urban growth have put pressure on the landscape for decades. Planners have drawn inspiration from a large African project that aims to hold back the spread of desert. The approach focuses on planting native species on degraded land to support ongoing afforestation. Nurseries are set up to grow saplings for continuing planting drives, so that seedlings are ready when they are needed. Damaged water bodies are also being restored. Invasive plant species are also removed. The work is coordinated centrally but depends on many partners, including non-governmental organisations, private companies and local communities. The National Forest Policy (1988) aims for at least one-third of total land area under forest or tree cover. The restoration is meant to control desertification, improve air quality and strengthen climate resilience in the Delhi-NCR region. Together, these measures aim to protect the region's green cover and water supply. The nurseries and planting drives span the states that the corridor crosses, including Haryana, Rajasthan, Gujarat and Delhi. Plantation work covers degraded land, and the approach relies on species that grow naturally in the region.

Q1.

What is the restoration target of the Aravalli Green Wall Project by 2027 (in million hectares)?

Answer: _____

Q2.

In which year was the Aravalli Green Wall Project launched?

Answer: _____

Q3.

Across how many districts does the Aravalli Green Wall Project cover (in number)?

Answer: _____

Q4.

Which national mission, part of the National Action Plan on Climate Change, aims to restore degraded ecosystems and enhance forest cover? (name the mission)

Answer: _____

Q5.

Under which programme is a 750-acre urban forest being developed in the Aravalli region?

Answer: _____

Q6.

What is India's Bonn Challenge target to restore degraded and deforested land by 2030 (in million hectares)?

Answer: _____

Planning and schemes check

Rural employment policy is being reshaped to match changes in the countryside. A legal guarantee of work has long been the base of the framework, but critics have pointed to scattered works and to assets that did not last. The proposed replacement treats planning as a village-level exercise. Gram panchayats prepare plans for their areas, and those plans are meant to be linked with larger infrastructure programmes so that core rural infrastructure, water and livelihood works are coordinated rather than separate. The local plans are then combined into a national picture, which the government says will support coordinated planning across the country.

Beyond wage work, the government runs several rural programmes. One helps self-help groups build self-employment and access finance. Another aims to build skills among rural youth. A further programme gives rural households records of their property, and another supports traditional artisans with skilling, toolkits and credit. Together, these measures are presented as part of a wider effort to promote livelihoods in villages.

The bill also seeks tighter monitoring. Officials plan to use digital tools, including biometric checks and data analytics, to reduce leakages and track work. Social audits are to be strengthened so that local communities can review how public money is spent.

Q1.

How many days of wage employment per rural household per financial year did MGNREGA guarantee? (in days)

Answer: _____

Q2.

What percentage share of funding does the Centre bear for States and UTs other than North-Eastern and Himalayan States under the bill? (in per cent)

Answer: _____

Q3.

Under MGNREGA, within how many days of completion of work were wages to be paid? (in days)

Answer: _____

Q4.

Which system aggregates the Viksit Gram Panchayat Plans for coordinated national planning? (give the abbreviation)

Answer: _____

Q5.

Viksit Gram Panchayat Plans are integrated with which scheme for infrastructure convergence? (name of the scheme)

Answer: _____

Q6.

Which scheme gives property cards to rural households? (give the acronym)

Answer: _____

Q7.

In which year was MGNREGA enacted? (year)

Answer: _____

Types of Lok Adalat

Lok Adalats take two main forms in the way they are organised. The National Lok Adalat is held at regular intervals across India on a single day, and in recent years it has also been held on a specific matter each month. The Permanent Lok Adalat is a different body, created to handle disputes

involving public utility services such as transportation. Its chairperson is a District Judge or an Additional District Judge, or a person who is or has been a District Judge or has held a judicial office higher in rank. The chairperson sits with persons who have adequate experience in public utility services. A Permanent Lok Adalat has no jurisdiction over any situation involving an offence that is not punishable by law. Its judgments are final and binding on all parties involved. The Supreme Court has described a Lok Adalat as purely conciliatory, which means it works by helping the parties reach an agreement rather than by imposing a decision. Both forms aim to settle disputes quickly and at low cost, without the long process of litigation. Together, they show how the Lok Adalat system combines flexibility with binding outcomes, so that a settlement reached before the forum carries real legal weight.

Q1.

In which year was the Legal Services Authorities Act, 1987 amended to permit the setting up of Permanent Lok Adalats? (year)

Answer: _____

Q2.

How many other persons with adequate experience in public utility services sit with the chairperson of a Permanent Lok Adalat? (in number)

Answer: _____

Q3.

Apart from transportation, which public utility service is cited as an example of disputes handled by Permanent Lok Adalats?

Answer: _____

Q4.

Which authority is the organising authority for Lok Adalats?

Answer: _____

Q5.

In which year did the Supreme Court decide State of Punjab vs Jalour Singh, holding that Lok Adalat is purely conciliatory? (year)

Answer: _____

Q6.

Since which year has the National Lok Adalat been held on a specific matter every month? (year)

Answer: _____

Q7.

In which state was the first Lok Adalat in India organised?

Answer: _____

UCC and courts: short answers

A Uniform Civil Code would mean one common set of personal laws that applies to all citizens, irrespective of their religious affiliation. The framers of the Constitution did not intend total uniformity in this area. The Central Government favours a common code, calling different matrimonial laws for various religions a threat to the nation's unity. The 2018 Law Commission report suggested reforming and codifying family laws across religions instead of pursuing a UCC at this stage. The Supreme Court has also referred to the matter in several judgments. In the Shah Bano case, the Court highlighted the need for uniformity in personal laws. Later rulings on talaq-e-biddat, also called triple talaq, dealt with a practice within personal law. The Court has also praised one Indian state that has a functioning UCC, calling it an example for others. The Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita 2023 also contains an offence for marrying again during the lifetime of a spouse,

which is punishable with imprisonment and a fine. Personal laws continue to differ across religions in matters of marriage and property, and this difference is the core of the debate. Together these strands show how the UCC debate connects constitutional text, legislative reform and judicial rulings.

Q1.

Under which Article of the Constitution is the state's duty to implement a Uniform Civil Code placed? (number only)

Answer: _____

Q2.

Which Act of 1954 allows inter-religious marriages while explicitly prohibiting polygamy? (name of the Act)

Answer: _____

Q3.

Personal laws were placed in which list of the Constitution? (name the list)

Answer: _____

Q4.

Which Indian state did the Supreme Court hail as a 'shining example' of a functioning UCC? (name of the state)

Answer: _____

Q5.

Which 2017 Supreme Court case held talaq-e-biddat (triple talaq) unconstitutional? (name of the case, first party)

Answer: _____

Q6.

Under which section of the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita 2023 is marrying again during the lifetime of a spouse an offence? (number only)

Answer: _____

Ways to steady the rupee

When the rupee faces sustained pressure, policymakers can work on several fronts at once. One approach is to reduce how much India's trade depends on the dollar, so that more transactions with partner countries are settled in the domestic currency. A second approach is to make the rupee easier to trade and hold outside India, which would widen its use in global markets. Strengthening the external sector is another route, and this includes maintaining healthy foreign exchange reserves. The central bank can also step into the currency market, selling or buying dollars as conditions require, and it can adjust interest rates. Over the longer term, attention turns to structural matters. Improving export competitiveness, attracting foreign direct investment through better infrastructure and regulation, and making it easier to do business are all part of this picture. Gold imports also weigh on the external balance, so reducing them is part of the broader effort. Policy choices are also shaped by the need to control inflation. Taken together, these steps aim to ease pressure on the currency gradually, rather than resolving it in a single move.

Q1.

Which type of accounts does the booklet propose to expand to promote rupee-based trade settlement? (name in full)

Answer: _____

Q2.

Which payment system's internationalisation does the booklet propose to boost global acceptance of the rupee? (short name)

Answer: _____

Q3.

Which global body's SDR basket does the booklet say the rupee should work towards being eligible for? (short name)

Answer: _____

Q4.

How many numbered measures are listed under 'How Can Rupee Be Stabilised?' (in number)

Answer: _____

Q5.

Apart from gold monetisation, which form of gold does the booklet name as a way to reduce gold imports? (two words)

Answer: _____

Q6.

Which Indian government securities does the booklet want included in global bond indices? (short form)

Answer: _____

Q7.

Along with Asia and the Gulf, which region's countries does the booklet name for local currency settlement agreements? (one word)

Answer: _____

MPC and Inflation Targeting: Typed Answer

India's monetary policy is framed within an inflation-targeting system. The Reserve Bank of India manages the money supply to achieve economic growth, which is different from fiscal policy handled by the Ministry of Finance. A statutory committee within the RBI decides the benchmark policy rate needed to keep inflation within a targeted range. The Central Government is empowered to constitute this committee, and its decisions are taken by majority vote. The Governor chairs it ex officio, and its decisions are binding on banks. India moved to flexible inflation targeting after an earlier expert panel formally set the target and its band. The inflation target is set by the government in consultation with the RBI. The RBI also releases a periodic report that explains the sources of inflation and its forecasts.

Q1.

How many members does the Monetary Policy Committee have? (number)

Answer: _____

Q2.

What is the minimum number of times the MPC must meet in a year? (number)

Answer: _____

Q3.

In the event of a tie in MPC voting, whose vote decides the outcome? (name the post)

Answer: _____

Q4.

Which committee formalised inflation targeting in India? (name)

Answer: _____

Q5.

What is the inflation target under India's framework? (in per cent)

Answer: _____

Q6.

In which year did India adopt flexible inflation targeting? (year)

Answer: _____

Q7.

What is the tolerance band on either side of the inflation target? (in percentage points)

Answer: _____

Defence and logistics facts

Defence cooperation remains one of the strongest pillars of India's partnership with Russia. The two countries have agreed on a reciprocal logistics arrangement that allows their armed forces to draw mutual support while operating away from home bases. Under this arrangement, each side can access the other's military facilities, ports and airspace, and it provides simplified refuelling and maintenance for deployments.

A high-level dialogue that brings together the foreign and defence ministers of both countries helps align their strategic priorities. Russia has long been among India's largest suppliers of defence equipment, and the two sides continue to pursue joint research, co-production under Make in India and transfer of military technology. Regular joint exercises between the armed forces add to this cooperation, and recent frigates have been commissioned into the Indian Navy.

Several major platforms reflect this partnership. A cruise missile is being developed jointly by an Indian research organisation and a Russian design bureau, while Indian production lines build multi-role fighter aircraft and main battle tanks based on Russian designs. India has also procured a long-range surface-to-air missile system from Russia, and a former Russian aircraft carrier has been refurbished for the Indian Navy.

Q1.

What percentage share of India's defence equipment supply did Russia account for? (in per cent)

Answer: _____

Q2.

In which year did India and Russia sign a new Treaty of Friendship and Cooperation after the dissolution of the Soviet Union?

Answer: _____

Q3.

Under what name was the former Russian aircraft carrier Admiral Gorshkov transferred to the Indian Navy after refurbishment?

Answer: _____

Q4.

Which cruise missile was jointly developed by India's DRDO and Russia's NPO Mashinostroyeniya (NPOM)?

Answer: _____

Q5.

Which Indian company produces the Sukhoi Su-30MKI multi-role fighter in India? (give the abbreviation)

Answer: _____

Q6.

By how many nautical miles does the proposed Chennai-Vladivostok sea route save distance over the existing route? (in nautical miles)

Answer: _____

Finance, Bonds and Cess

India's financial policy has recently moved on several fronts at once. The central bank has released a fresh national roadmap to widen financial inclusion over the coming years. It rests on the idea that access, gender sensitivity, livelihoods, financial education and customer protection must move together, so that no group is left behind. Indian entities have also long used rupee-denominated debt sold in overseas markets to attract foreign investment and reduce their dependence on domestic borrowing. Parliament has taken up changes to insurance law that would let foreign investors hold a larger stake in insurance companies and strengthen the regulator's enforcement powers. On the revenue side, the government raises money through taxes, cesses and surcharges, and each is governed differently. A cess is levied for a specific purpose and used only for that purpose, while a surcharge adds to the Union's revenue without any specific earmarking. A new cess bill has also been proposed for goods that carry high health costs. Together, these measures show how the state balances revenue needs, public welfare and investor confidence in a changing economy. Economists and policy analysts often compare how different revenue tools share money between the Union and the states, because the choice of tool determines who benefits. Such comparisons help students understand why the same economy can be funded through very different instruments for very different purposes.

Q1.

Masala bonds are governed by which central bank?

Answer: _____

Q2.

In which year did the International Finance Corporation introduce masala bonds?

Answer: _____

Q3.

Under the Pradhan Mantri Jan Dhan Yojana, over how many crore bank accounts were opened? (in crore)

Answer: _____

Q4.

Under the Sabka Bima Sabki Raksha (Amendment of Insurance Laws) Bill 2025, what is the new FDI limit in Indian insurance companies? (in per cent)

Answer: _____

Q5.

How many key pillars does the National Strategy for Financial Inclusion 2025-30 define?

Answer: _____

Q6.

What is the name of the pool through which taxes are shared with states?

Answer: _____

Q7.

Which product is given as an initial example of goods covered by the Health Security and National Security Cess Bill 2025?

Answer: _____

Repo Cut, D-SIBs and Economic Census

Economic news in December 2025 focused on how stable the Indian economy looked and how the banking system is being watched more closely. The Reserve Bank of India, which decides monetary policy, recently reduced its key policy rate by a quarter of a percentage point. The central bank described the situation as a rare Goldilocks phase, a term that describes an economy in a balanced state. In such a phase, growth is steady, inflation is low, employment is high and the economy shows no sign of overheating or recession. Regulators have also taken steps to strengthen the largest banks. Some banks are so large and so closely connected with the rest of the system that their failure could disrupt the entire economy, so they must hold extra capital. For customers, the RBI's grievance system has been reorganised. A single integrated scheme now handles complaints against banks, non-banking finance companies and other regulated entities, with the aim of resolving disputes quickly, transparently and at low cost. Looking ahead, the government will conduct another Economic Census once the population census is complete, with the data expected to support a unified business register and better planning for enterprises across the country. Together, these measures show how monetary policy, banking regulation, consumer protection and statistics work as connected parts of the financial system.

Q1.

What is the RBI's repo rate after its December 2025 cut? (in per cent)

Answer: _____

Q2.

Up to how many lakh rupees can an Ombudsman direct a regulated entity to pay as compensation for financial loss? (in lakh)

Answer: _____

Q3.

What is the informal term used for Domestic Systemically Important Banks?

Answer: _____

Q4.

Which authority designates the D-SIBs?

Answer: _____

Q5.

How many earlier ombudsman schemes does the Integrated Ombudsman Scheme 2021 merge? (in number)

Answer: _____

Q6.

In which year will India conduct its next Economic Census?

Answer: _____